

Ariel O. Saracho

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Research Fields

Primary: International Trade; International Macroeconomics. **Secondary:** Firm Dynamics; Financial Frictions.

Education

University of Rochester, Ph.D. in Economics	Expected 2027
Dissertation committee: George Alessandria (advisor), Fernando Parro, Yan Bai.	
University of Rochester, M.A. in Economics	2024
National University of Tucuman, M.A. in Economics	2022
National University of Tucuman, B.A. in Economics	2020
Scholarship for academic merit; B.A. completed in the 95th percentile of the 2020 cohort.	

Research

Inventories, Trade Credit, and Imported Inputs in Firm Dynamics

Job-market paper; with Jiri Havel; preliminary draft available on request; expected full draft Fall 2026

This paper studies how trade credit, inventory buffers, imported-input use, and supplier financing interact in firm dynamics. We use confidential Belgian firm-level customs and balance-sheet data accessed through the National Bank of Belgium under a confidentiality agreement to measure links among import exposure, inventories, accounts payable, supplier finance, and firm outcomes. The empirical part documents how firms exposed to imported inputs differ in inventory holdings, payment terms, financing needs, and subsequent performance. We build a dynamic model in which firms face stochastic demand, choose prices and inventory investment, and finance input purchases either upfront or through trade credit. Sales are constrained by inventories, and trade credit accumulates as a short-term liability with increasing marginal cost, capturing financing frictions and implicit credit limits. The model quantifies how changes in the availability or cost of trade credit affect inventory policies, firm growth, and exit, particularly in trade-intensive sectors. The project connects firm-finance frictions to supply-chain resilience and to the transmission of financial conditions across firms that depend on imported intermediates.

From Fewer Workers to Fewer Exporters? Population Growth and Exporter Dynamics

Working paper; with Kazuma Inagaki; draft available on request; presented at ETSG 2025

This paper studies how demographic change affects exporter dynamics. We develop a dynamic heterogeneous-firm model with sunk export costs in which population growth drives firm entry and variety expansion. In partial equilibrium, a decline in labor-force growth reduces firm entry, shifts the firm-size distribution toward larger and more productive incumbents, and raises the share of exporters. We extend the model to general equilibrium with endogenous wages and semi-endogenous growth, calibrate it to U.S. Business Dynamics Statistics and Census of Manufactures moments, and simulate the transition from 1940 to 2025, focusing on the 1978–2019 rise in exporter participation. The model implies that a one percentage point reduction in labor-force growth increases the exporter share by about 1.1 percentage points and accounts for only a small fraction of the observed rise in U.S. exporter participation. Using U.S. state-level data and lagged birth rates as an instrument for labor-force growth, we estimate an elasticity of exporter share to labor-force growth of similar magnitude and document the entry-rate channel behind the mechanism. An accounting exercise with wedges in entry, variable trade, and sunk export costs indicates that changes in trade costs, rather than demographics, are the dominant force behind increased trade integration.

Disclosed Supply-Chain Risk, Inventory Adjustment, and the Trade-Credit Channel

Work in progress; solo-authored project; preliminary draft expected Spring 2027

This project uses the universe of U.S. public-firm SEC filings to build disclosure-based measures of supply-chain, trade-credit, and working-capital risk. The project asks whether firm disclosures contain real-time information about firms' real and financial adjustment. Using 136,056 filings from 2018–2024, I study whether risk language predicts future inventory accumulation, receivables, payables, and supply-chain adjustment. The evidence points to an asymmetry in information content: supply-chain risk language is forward-looking and predicts future inventory accumulation, especially raw-material buffers, while trade-credit language mainly describes contemporaneous receivables and payables. At the aggregate level, however, leave-one-out industry trade-credit risk predicts firms' payables adjustment, suggesting that trade-credit tightening is difficult to detect in a single firm's own disclosure but becomes visible in industry-level risk language.

Research Experience

Research Assistant	2024–2025
<i>University of Rochester / NBER project; Supervisor: George Alessandria</i>	

Studied shipment alternatives in inventory models and the macroeconomic consequences of firm-level shipment choices. Solved computational models for dynamic inventory and shipment-choice analysis for a joint project with Kim Ruhl.

Research Assistant	Summer 2025
<i>University of Rochester; Supervisor: Rafael Guntin</i>	

Analyzed sectoral responses to sudden-stop episodes in advanced and emerging markets; processed and harmonized input-output tables for the research project “Do Crises Shape the Economic Structure?” with Rafael Guntin and Lucia Casal.

Research Assistant

Spring 2023

University of Rochester; Supervisor: Matias Moretti

Worked on idiosyncratic risk, geographic diversification, and concentration in the U.S. banking industry for the research project “Geographic Funding Risk and Market Power in Deposit Markets” by Matias Moretti, Juan Morelli, and Venky Venkateswaran.

Research Assistant

2019

Supervisor: Victor Elias

Supported labor-economics research using U.S. and Eurostat panel data on educational wage premia, vocational and general training, human-capital investment, and unemployment outcomes.

Research and Teaching Assistant

2019–2021

National University of Tucuman; Supervisor: Maria Jose Granados

Supported research and teaching in applied economics and international trade, including time-series analysis, ARIMA models, seasonal adjustment, cycle-trend filters, Ricardian and Heckscher-Ohlin models, and Melitz-style exporter-firm models.

Teaching Experience

Instructor, ECON 204: Principles of Macroeconomics, Rochester Education Justice Initiative, Groveland Correctional Facility Fall 2026

Instructor, ECON 209: Intermediate Macroeconomics, University of Rochester Summer 2026

Teaching Assistant, ECON 270: International Macroeconomics, University of Rochester Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, ECON 209: Intermediate Macroeconomics, University of Rochester Fall 2024

Presentations

European Trade Study Group Conference, Milan; presented “From Fewer Workers to Fewer Exporters? Population Growth and Exporter Dynamics” 2025

Graduate Day, University of Rochester; presented research in progress 2024

Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

University of Rochester Ph.D. Scholarship/Funding Package 2022–2027

University of Rochester Economics Department Research Fellowship Fall 2023; Summer 2024

Travel Grant, European Trade Study Group Conference, Milan 2025

Academic Merit Scholarship, National University of Tucuman 2020–2022

Ever Better Graduate Mentor Recognition 2021

Professional and Policy Experience

Head of Economic Indicators 2021–2022

State Statistics Department, Tucuman Government

Led a four-person team and coordinated with three senior economists from an external partner group. Produced monthly and annual regional indicators, including the official Tucuman consumer price index, gross provincial product, construction price index, and labor and trade indicators, used by government agencies, citizens, consulting firms, and judicial processes.

Data Analyst 2019–2021

Construction Trade Association, Tucuman

Estimated the construction price index for the main private association in the regional construction sector and maintained recurring data workflows tracking construction costs and regional price dynamics.

Freelance Researcher 2019–2022

Public centers and private clients

Produced market-analysis studies, including research on the software labor market in Spain and export-potential assessments for Tucuman goods and services.

Publications and Reports

Saracho, Ariel O. “Synthetic Index of Business Cycle of Tucuman: State-Space Model Estimation.” ARESNOA, 2021.

Saracho, Ariel O. “New Equipment, Same Old Measures? Capital Composition in Development Accounting.” AAEP Working Papers, No. 4406, 2020.

Service and Leadership

Graduate Housing Coordinator, University of Rochester 2024–Present

Organize community-building events and resident engagement initiatives for Graduate and Family Housing.

Skills

Programming/statistical tools: Julia, Python, R, Stata/Mata, SQL, MATLAB, GAMS. **Software:** LaTeX, Excel, PowerPoint, Power BI, EViews, GRET. **Languages:** Spanish (native); English (C1; TOEFL 107).